



CII-Shiksha: An Endeavour to Simplify Education

CII-Shiksha, a non-profit organisation, has undertaken many initiatives to empower the teaching/learning process. All these initiatives have been delivered totally free of cost to the stakeholders of the education ecosystem

Sudeshna Das

Education process is very dynamic these days and every component in education—curriculum, assessment, teaching-learning or process—needs strategies in tune with the changing demands. These strategies can be ensured and put in place and practice by adopting the latest trends in technology.

"For us, teacher empowerment is about building e-capabilities in teachers to enable them to integrate technology more effectively in their teaching. These e-capabilities empower teachers to use technology (software, tool, equipment, etc) to perform a variety of tasks like content delivery, building collaboration among students, creating interactive courses, etc. Teaching is all about maximising learning in all types of learners and technology empowers teachers to do so by using tools, software, equipment, etc that cater to different learner types (visual, auditory and kinesthetic). Empowering teachers with technology would ensure a multisensory approach to teaching-learning, thereby making it more effective and impactful," opines Narinder Bhatia, director-education, Shiksha India.

Modus operandi

CII-Shiksha has created an eight-component model to deliver the programme and to ensure a meaningful impact on the teaching-learning process in the schools. The schools put in their efforts by way of three components, which are computers,

connectivity and commitment. CII-Shiksha provides content, coaching and the three communication components to the programme. The outcomes of the mutual contribution are two components—creativity and collaboration.

Shiksha provides multimedia content in Hindi, English and Tamil for 12-16-years age-group. The content covers 32 modules from physics, chemistry, biology, mathematics and geography. A free collaborative and sharing portal (www.eshikshaindia.in) was created to allow teachers to share their resources and best practices and work together with their peers on various ICT-based and creative teaching-learning resources. The portal also hosts content created by Shiksha teachers for free download under student section. All Shiksha content is also available for free download from the portal.

Free e-Academy for Teachers (www.eshikshaacademy.in)—a roaming teacher empowerment academy—allows interested schools and teachers to nominate

themselves for the e-Teaching Workshops by Shiksha. Through a process of resource screening, teachers are selected for participation in various e-teaching workshops organised in various parts of the country.

Since CII-Shiksha thrives heavily on open source/free tools and technologies, various subject-specific projects have been undertaken in using open source tools specific to the subject. The teachers involved with CII-Shiksha Programme have collaboratively worked to create free open source curriculum in computer science for 6th-8th standards containing a collection of open source/free tools to deliver capabilities for animation, programming, html designing, etc in children; free interactive resources in geometry and algebra for class 9th; and free HTML e-lessons/courses in mathematics for class 10th.

Moreover, CII-Shiksha has introduced a variety of offline open source tools and teachers have used these to create their own lessons and courses for

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